



The Garamut “The message sender”

Ps Barry Reflections from ‘The WORD’!

**For PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION & PERSONAL
PROGRESS**

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THE THEME: PRESUMPTION BEING PRESUMPTUOUS

There are times that we have been reminded not to be presumptuous, where we tend to be quick to form opinions about people or situations that find ourselves in. Where we attribute certain attitudes or motives to people's actions. In recent weeks I found myself being challenged in this matter, resulting in a prayer to God for help.

My prayer:

“Lord keep me from being presumptuous.”

“Lord help me to refrain from quickly presuming certain attitudes and motives behind some people's actions.”

Yes, we do need to have Godly discernment about people and certain things but not without substantive evidence. Too often I have been too quick in formulating opinions about some people's behaviour without taking time to reflect upon what issues or struggles or tragedies people have experienced or are currently facing.

Presumptuousness is the quality of being bold or self-assured by doing things or making assumptions that we have no right to make. It shows a lack of respect for proper limits, rules, or other people's boundaries.

Characteristics of Presumptuousness.

- **Overstepping boundaries**, - taking liberties or acting with a false sense of entitlement.
- **Unwarranted confidence**, - assuming we know what other people want, think, or feel without asking or finding out from them or someone who does know the person.
- **Disrespectful**, - ignoring social or cultural standards, official status, or personal space.

1. **PRESUMPTUOUSNESS REMOVES CHOICE.** This is where we decide for others and do not allow them to express their feelings and make their own decisions. Where we have already presumed that certain people would not be interested in doing or what they might prefer without asking them.
Romans 14:4 Who are you to judge someone else's servant? To his own master he stands or falls NIV.
2. **PRESUMPTUOUSNESS LACKS HUMILITY.** Because it assumes we know what they are thinking and feeling (attitudes and motives) about certain matters.
3. **PRESUMPTUOUSNESS CAUSES FRICTION IN RELATIONSHIPS.** And this often lead to false accusations and misrepresentation.
4. **PRESUMPTUOUSNESS MAY PROJECT ONES' OWN INSECURITIES.** It is possible that presumptuousness can be a means where we project our own insecurities of poor self-image, identity crisis onto another person.
5. **BEING PRESUMPTUOUS CAN LEAD TO FANTASIES.** A **fantasy** is an idea, a story, or a mental image created by the imagination that cannot happen in the real world. But there are people today who live in a fantasy world of their own making, where they imagine (invent) an idea or scenario that has no basis in the truth.

In Biblical terms, we would call this self-deception (this is connected to pride).

Galatians 6:3 For if anyone considers himself to be something when he is nothing, he is deceiving himself. Holman

6. PRESUMPTUOUS IN RELATION TO THE CALL OF GOD ON OUR LIVES.

The danger of presuming certain things about the call of God on our lives that God did not ascribe to is dangerous and goes beyond the boundaries that God ordained.

To do that is to seriously miss God's ways of fulfilling his plan and also be out of sync with his timing and schedule.

7. PRESUMPTUOUS IN RELATION TO PREDICTING HOW GOD WILL RESPOND.

Matthew 19:13-15

13 Then little children were brought to Jesus for him to place his hands on them and pray for them. But the disciples rebuked those who brought them. 14 Jesus said, "Let the little children come to me, and do not hinder them, for the kingdom of heaven belongs to such as these." 15 When he had placed his hands on them, he went on from there. NIV

The disciples wrongly presumed what Jesus' response would be about the parents bringing their children to Jesus to be blessed – that's why he rebuked them. This is contrasted with the response of Jesus - "Let them come to me, and do not hinder them." Their presumption was misplaced.

8. PRESUMPTUOUS IN RELATION TO CIRCUMSTANCES AND EVENTS THAT HAPPEN TO OUR LIVES.

Do not give in to the temptation to presume it is God's punishment or he has forsaken or forgotten you.

Genesis 50:20 You plotted evil against me, but God turned it into good, in order to preserve the lives of many people who are alive today because of what happened. GNT

Romans 8:28 And we know that God causes everything to work together for the good of those who love God and are called according to his purpose for them. NLT

Moses as an example.

Moses presumed too much about God using him to deliver Israel from Egypt's slavery – read Acts 7:22-29

Acts 7:25 He supposed his brethren to be aware that by him God was sending them deliverance; this, however, they did not understand. WEYMOUTH. Several translations use the word "supposed" referring to Moses mindset.

The word "supposed" in the original Greek language means to consider, think, suppose, or assume something to be true, based on one's own reasoning, mindset, or cultural expectation.

Here Stephen the writer of Acts is describing how Moses assumed or held the mental expectation (enomizen) that his fellow Israelites would naturally realize God was using him to rescue them, though they did not yet understand it. But Moses had already killed the Egyptian presuming that his brethren would support him – which they did not – because they said: Exodus 2:14. "And who are you?" the man demanded. "I suppose you think you are our prince and judge! And do you plan to kill me as you did that Egyptian yesterday?" When Moses realized that his deed was known, he was frightened. TLB

Miriam, Moses's sister supported by AARON Moses older brother **PRESUMED** that because they as part of the family, they had the right to criticise Moses about his choice of an Ethiopian wife and about God's Choice of Moses as leader and deliverer.

Miriam presumed – but wrongly and this made God angry and she became leprous - Numbers 12: 1,2,10 "Then Miriam and Aaron criticized Moses because of the Cushite woman he had married, for he had taken a Cushite wife. 'Has the Lord spoken only through Moses?' they asked. 'Hasn't he also spoken through us?' And the Lord heard this." 10 Miriam suddenly became white with leprosy. TLB

Other examples of persons who presumed.

The Israelites at Hormah (Numbers 14:40-45): After being rebuked for rebellion, the people **PRESUMED** they could go up and fight the Amalekites despite Moses warning them God was not with them; they were beaten back.

King Uzziah (2 Chronicles 26:16-21): Grown strong in his reign, Uzziah grew prideful and **PRESUMED** to enter the temple of the Lord to burn incense on the altar, a duty reserved only for consecrated priests. He was struck with leprosy.

The Gibeonites' Deception & Israel's Failure (Joshua 9:14-15): The leaders of Israel made a treaty with the Gibeonites without asking counsel from the Lord, **PRESUMING** they knew the situation based on mouldy bread and worn clothes.

Peter (Matthew 26:33-35): Peter confidently **PRESUMED** his own spiritual strength, declaring that even if everyone else fell away on account of Jesus, he never would. He denied Christ three times before morning.

The sons of Zebedee and their mother (Matthew 20:20-22): They **PRESUMED** to request places of highest honour at Jesus' right and left hands in His kingdom without understanding what it entailed.

The rich fool (Luke 12:16-21): A man **PRESUMED** upon a long, secure future of ease and plenty ("soul, you have many goods laid up for many years; take your ease"), only to die that very night.

May our prayer be constant in asking God to keep us from being presumptuous and help us to pause, listen and allow the Holy Spirit to be more discerning.

Amen Ps Barry.